VPN connection fails: collect evidence and route safely

SAH-VPN-001 | Version 1.0 | Category: vpn | 14 October 2026

SYNTHETIC DEMO CONTENT - not approved company policy. Employee checks only. No autonomous system changes.

APPLIES TO

Synthetic POC triage scenario for an unspecified company VPN. No VPN product, gateway address, error-code mapping or company procedure has been supplied. This is a handoff guide, not a vendor-specific repair.

CLARIFY FIRST

Ask for the VPN application name, the exact visible error text or code, when the failure began, and whether ordinary permitted websites open. Do not ask for credentials, MFA codes, recovery codes or full diagnostic logs.

EMPLOYEE CHECKS

1. Ask the employee to test a familiar permitted website. If it fails, use the network guide first.
2. If browsing works but VPN fails, record that distinction and the visible VPN error.
3. If the message mentions a certificate, access denial or account lockout, stop attempts and hand off.
4. For any other persistent VPN error, hand off with the observations; this pilot has no supported vendor-specific repair.

STOP AND HAND OFF

Do not interpret an unfamiliar error code from memory. Do not disable certificate checks, change the VPN gateway, reinstall software, bypass MFA or repeatedly retry authentication. Engineer follow-up is required when this guide cannot resolve the issue.

COMPLETION EVIDENCE

Do not declare success because ordinary internet browsing works. VPN access is a separate requirement. Record explicit employee confirmation only if they report that the original VPN task now works.

PROVENANCE

Original synthetic scenario written for the Sahayak POC on 2026-10-14. Its handoff and confirmation rules derive from the project technical requirements; it is not a published company or VPN-vendor procedure.